

6.2.2 Plagiarism (including AI misuse)

When producing final 'written' pieces of work for the set assignments, students must use their own words to show they have genuinely applied their knowledge and understanding. When students use their own words, ideas and opinions, it reduces the possibility of their work being identified as plagiarised. Plagiarism is:

- the submission of someone else's work as your own
- failure to acknowledge a source correctly, including any use of written material, the internet or Artificial Intelligence (AI).

You might find the following JCQ documents helpful:

- [Plagiarism in Assessments](#)
- [AI Use in Assessments: Protecting the Integrity of Qualifications](#)

Plagiarism (including AI misuse) makes up a large percentage of cases of suspected malpractice reported to us by moderators. Teachers must ensure students understand they must not include plagiarised work as evidence.

Plagiarism (including AI misuse) often occurs innocently when students do not know that they must reference or acknowledge their sources or aren't sure how to do so. It's important to make sure your students understand:

- the meaning of plagiarism (including AI misuse) and what penalties may be applied

- that they can refer to research, quotations or evidence produced by somebody else but they must list and reference their sources and clearly mark quotations
- quoting someone else's work, even when it's properly sourced and referenced, doesn't evidence understanding. The student must 'do' something with that information to show they understand it. For example, if a student has to analyse data from an experiment, quoting data doesn't show that they understand what it means. The student must interpret the data and, by relating it to their assignment, say what they think it means. The work must clearly show how the student is using the material they have referenced **to inform their** thoughts, ideas or conclusions.

We have a [Guide to referencing](#) on our website. We have also produced a [poster](#) about referencing and plagiarism which may be useful to share with students.

You must teach your students:

- to always reference or acknowledge material copied from the internet or other sources. This applies to infographics (graphical information providing data or knowledge) as well

- how to reference and explain why it's important to do it. They must:
 - use quote marks to show the beginning and end of the copied work
 - for website text, to list the html address and ideally the date they accessed the website
 - show the name of any AI source used and the date the content was generated for computer-generated content (such as an AI Chatbot)
 - retain a copy of the question(s) and computer-generated content for reference, assessment and authentication purposes (see [JCQ Guidance](#) for full requirements)
 - for other publications, to list the name of the resource/book/printed article and ideally the year in which it was published.
- to identify information they have copied from teaching handouts and presentations for the unit, using quote marks and stating the text is from class handouts.

Identifying copied/plagiarised work

Inconsistencies throughout a student's response are often indicators of plagiarism. For example:

- different tones of voice, sentence structure and formality across pieces of work
- use of American expressions, spellings and contexts (such as American laws and guidelines)
- dated expressions and references to past events as being current
- sections of text in a document where the font or format is inconsistent with other sections.

What to do if you think a student has plagiarised

If you identify plagiarised work at the point of marking or moderation:

- this must be taken into account when applying the mark scheme.
 - the work **must** be included with any work that is sent to the moderator if it is part of the moderation sample, with a note on the Unit Recording Sheet to state that there is plagiarism in the work and that marks have been adjusted accordingly
- the student(s) must be reported for plagiarism in line with the JCQ document [Suspected Malpractice Policies and Procedures](#)
 - Fill in the JCQ [form M1](#)

In line with the policy and procedures of JCQ on suspected malpractice, the sanctions applied for plagiarism (including AI misuse) could result in a warning, loss of marks or loss of aggregation or certification opportunity.

6.3 Feedback

Feedback to students on work in progress towards summative assessment

You can discuss work-in-progress towards summative assessment with students to make sure it's being done in a planned and timely way. It also provides an opportunity to check the authenticity of the work. You must intervene if there's a health and safety risk.

Generic guidance to the whole class is also allowed. This could include reminding students to check they have provided evidence to cover every aspect of the task. Individual students can be prompted to double check for gaps in evidence providing that specific gaps are not pointed out to them.

You can give general feedback and support if one or more students are struggling to get started on an aspect of the assignment or following a break between sessions working on the assignment. For example,

if a student is seeking more guidance that suggests they are not able to apply knowledge, skills and understanding to complete their evidence you can remind them that they had a lesson which covered the relevant topic. The student would then need to review their own notes to find this information and apply it as needed.

Feedback must not provide specific advice and guidance that would be construed as coaching. This would compromise the student's ability to independently perform the task(s) they are doing and constitutes malpractice. Our moderators use a number of measures to assure themselves the work is the student's own.

If an individual student needs additional help or support because they are struggling to start a task or part of a task that is **critical to them accessing the rest of the task or assignment**, this **must** be recorded on the student's work and/or Unit Recording Sheet (URS) for our Moderator to see. In this situation, the student should **not** be awarded the marks for the work for which they received help.

Assessing completed work

When students have completed all their work on an assignment, you must assess it (mark it) and give feedback to them. Assessment should not be an iterative process. This means you must not assess work and give feedback on it in stages. You must only assess the work when the assignment is complete.

Feedback **must**:

- be supportive, encouraging and positive
- tell the student what has been noticed, not what you think (for example if you have observed the student completing a task you can describe what happened, what was produced and what was demonstrated)

Feedback **can**:

- identify what task and part of the task could be improved, but not detail how to improve it. You could show the student work from a **different** unit that demonstrates higher achievement, but you must not detail to the student how they could achieve that in their work. If you are using another student's work as a model answer, please anonymise this work. You could remind students that they had a lesson on a specific topic and that they could review their notes, but you must not tell them how they could apply the teaching to improve their work.
- comment on what has been achieved, for example 'the evidence shows a **sound** understanding for MB2'
- identify that the student hasn't met a descriptor word or mark band requirement. For example, 'This is a description, not an evaluation'
- identify what area of work could be improved but not detail how to improve it. For example, students can be reminded that they had a lesson on this specific topic and could review their notes but cannot be told how to apply the teaching to improve the work
- include the teacher using text from the specification, assignment or marking criteria in general guidance to clarify what is needed in the work. For example 'To improve your mark

you need to consider the bulleted advice given in the Tips section regarding the aims of your research and which sampling method is likely to provide you with the most useful findings. You have given a **comprehensive** justification of the sampling method(s) to be used, evidencing **clear** understanding, but only a **sound** explanation of the overall aims of the market research'

- point out where the work sits within the mark bands but students must make their own decisions as to what to improve and how. For example, the feedback can say 'this shows a **sound** understanding' (for mark band 2) but not precisely what should be added to make it show a **comprehensive** understanding (for mark band 3).

Feedback **must not**:

- point out specific gaps, for example you must not prompt the student to include specific detail in their work, such as 'You need to improve this by giving more detail'
- be so detailed that it
 - leads students to the answer, for example you must not give model answers on the **same** unit being taken or explain specifically what amendments should be made. If work from another student on a **different unit** is being used to model answers, please ensure it is anonymised.
 - provides a step-by-step guide on what to do to complete or improve work, for example you must not give headings or templates that include examples which give all or part of what students have to write about or produce.
- talk the student through how to achieve or complete the task.
- give detail on where to find information/evidence.

In other words, feedback must help the student to take the initiative in making changes. It must not direct or tell the student what to do to complete or improve their work in a way that means they do not need to think how to apply their learning. Students need to recall or apply their learning. You must not do the work for the student(s).

Neither you nor the student can add, amend or remove any work after the final mark has been submitted for moderation.

Please see additional guidance for students who wish to resubmit their work in [Section 6.4.4](#).

Informing students of their marks

When you have marked students' work, you must inform students of the marks achieved. **Before** you submit marks to us, you must provide enough time for:

- students to appeal the marks.

- you to complete a review and make changes if needed.
- you to inform students of the outcome of the review.

What improper assistance might look like

When we see anything that suggests the teacher has led students to the answer, we become concerned because it suggests students have not worked independently to produce their assignment work. The following are examples of what may indicate improper assistance by the teacher:

- prompts that instruct students to include specific detail in their work, such as correcting the financial calculations for the pricing strategy
- headings or templates that include examples which give all or part of what students have to write about or produce, such as a list of everything needed to be covered in the evaluation of the pitch

Moderators will report suspected malpractice when they cannot see differences in content between students' work in the sample they are moderating. An exception is when students have only used and referenced technical facts and definitions. If the moderator is in any doubt, they will report suspected malpractice. The decision on whether or not to investigate is made by us not the moderator.